Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 6 2
♥ A 10 9
♦ A K 3
♣ A K 8 4

♠ Q J 8 5
♥ 8 7 6 5 2
♦ 6 5
♣ 5 2

♠ 10 9 4 3
♥ Q J 4
♦ 10
♣ Q J 10 9 3

♠ A 7
♥ K 3
♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2
♣ 7 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	7NT
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings

7NT by North
Lead: ♣Q

SOUTH isn't sure just how much he can make, but surely 6♦ isn't too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and NORTH shows three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and NORTH shows three.

Hmm, SOUTH can now count all thirteen tricks, so he forgets about the ♦ slam and bids 7NT.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 9 7 4 2 ♥ A 10 8 5 3 ♦ J 10 ♣ 3 2	
♠ J 8 ♥ J 7 2 ♦ 8 5 ♣ A K Q 10 9 6	N W E S	♠ A K Q ♥ K Q 6 ♦ K Q 3 ♣ J 8 7 5
	♠ 10 6 5 3 ♥ 9 4 ♦ A 9 7 6 4 2 ♣ 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♥	Pass
4NT			
All Pass			

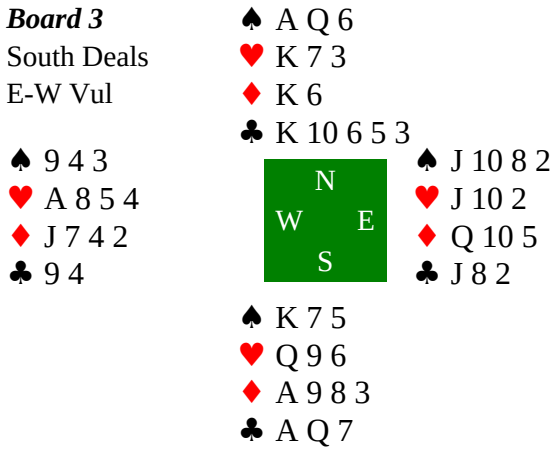
4NT by East
Lead: ♥9

WEST has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			

4NT by South
Lead: ♥4

Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

NORTH has a 16 points and SOUTH has 15, 16 or 17. NORTH wants to be in 6NT if SOUTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, SOUTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 10 5 3 ♥ A 4 3 2 ♦ Q 10 9 2 ♣ 9 3	
♠ A 8 7 6 ♥ Q J 7 ♦ A J 3 ♣ A 8 2		♠ K Q J 4 ♥ K 6 ♦ K 4 ♣ K Q J 10 5
	♠ 9 2 ♥ 10 9 8 5 ♦ 8 7 6 5 ♣ 7 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	4♣	Pass
4NT	Pass	6NT	
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♠5

When WEST opens 1NT EAST hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K ♥ A Q 10 9 6 ♦ A Q J 3 ♣ A K	
♠ 8 5 4 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 8 6 4 ♣ Q 10 3		♠ Q J 10 6 ♥ 8 2 ♦ 9 5 2 ♣ J 9 8 5
	♠ 9 7 2 ♥ K J 5 3 ♦ K 7 ♣ 7 6 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♣[2]
Pass	5NT[3]	Pass	6♥[4]
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 0 or 4 aces
3. asks for kings
4. 2 kings

7NT by North
Lead: ♠Q

NORTH has a pretty good hand, and when SOUTH shows ♥ support she naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because that has a different meaning, so she goes through the 4NT sequence even though she already knows the Ace answer.

Finding SOUTH with two Kings was what she wanted.

Board 6
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ J 8 4 3 ♥ J 7 6 2 ♦ 6 3 ♣ 10 9 3	
♠ K 7 ♥ K 9 ♦ A Q J 10 4 ♣ A Q J 7	N W E S	♠ A 6 2 ♥ A 10 4 ♦ K 7 5 ♣ K 8 6 2
	♠ Q 10 9 5 ♥ Q 8 5 3 ♦ 9 8 2 ♣ 5 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♠	Pass
5♣	Pass	5♠	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			

7NT by East
Lead: ♠10

WEST is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when EAST shows 13-15 points WEST wants to be in a slam.

WEST cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with EAST's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in WEST's hand so he bids 7NT.